

Second Game Suspended With Pels Ahead In 6th

By JACK DOANE
Assistant Sports Editor

The New Orleans Pelicans spoiled the Montgomery Rebels' home opener in the Southern Association at Pater-son Field yesterday by capturing a 2-0 victory in the first game of a scheduled doubleheader. The second game was suspended at the end of the sixth frame with the Pels ahead, 3-2.

A crowd of 4,377 excited, base-ball-frenzied fans turned out to see the Rebels look impressive, even if defeat, in their first game of the year here. Both tilts were stir-ring pitchers' battles with fielding gems keeping the fans gasping throughout the afternoon.

In pre-game ceremonies Ben Galtsman, who was instrumental in bringing Southern League ball to Montgomery, introduced Gen-eral Manager Ray Winder who in turn introduced Pelican Manager Andy Cohen. Cohen introduced his players as did Manager Steve Soudchuck of the Rebels.

Right-hander Hy Cohen outdueled the Johnny Rebs' Van Fletcher in the first tilt. Cohen limited the locals to three scattered hits and was never in serious trouble. He walked three men and fanned two.

Fletcher matched Cohen all the way. He allowed only four hits until the eighth inning when the Pels collected their two runs. The fast-balling Reb righty had a no-bitter until the fifth but began to tire under the hot sun and the in-vaders started to find the range.

Two of the Reb hits were dou-bles, one by left fielder Clyde Vol-lmer, former Washington Senator and Boston Red Sox star, and the other by right fielder Dixie Up-right. Fletcher had the only other Reb hit, a single to right in the third.

No man in either lineup had more than one hit in the first tilt. All of the hits off Fletcher and Bill Voiselle, who came in in the ninth after Fletcher was halted for in the bottom of the eighth, were singles.

The first game was highlighted by four twin killings by the Rebs' flashy infield. New Orleans had one.

Joe Tully of the locals and Don Dangleis of the Pelicans hooked up in another mound duel in the scheduled seven-inning nightcap. Tully was relieved by Voiselle in the top of the sixth with two out. Dick Barone was the hitting star in the finale for the Pels with a double and two singles. He had two of the New Orleans' hits until the fatal sixth when the Pels scored their three runs.

Centerfielder Billy Wells was the only local to get more than one safety in the second tilt. He had a double in the second inning and a single in the bottom of the sixth that drove home the second Mont-gomery run. Upright had his sec-ond double of the day in the second game.

Manager Steve Soudchuck an-nounced last night that Charles Frazier (2-3), will be on the mound for the Rebs tonight in Atlanta. The locals return home next Mon-day night against the Nashville Vol-s.

R. C. Otey walked as the first Montgomery batter of the year in the first game but was quickly wiped out as third baseman Vern Piver of the Pels made a stellar stop of Billy Wells' sharp hopper and started a twin killing. Dixie Upright grounded out to second to end the frame.

Vollmer had the first hit of the season for the new Rebs, a lead off double in the second against the right field wall, but Cohen bore down and retired the next three men without further damage.

Fletcher rifled a single to right with one away in the third frame but was forced at second by Otey, who in turn was caught stealing on a close play at second.

Fletcher was a picture of per-fectness through the first four in-nings, retiring the first 13 men to face him. Emil Panko led off the fifth with a solid single to left, but A. Grunwald lined out to left and Jim Rice hit into a double play, third to second to first.

The Pels connected for two singles in the sixth as Piver led off with a single to center but a twin killing wiped him out, then Cohen singled to right, but Dick Barone popped out to short to end the frame.

The Rebs put up the first serious threat of the game in the bottom of the seventh but to no avail. Upright led off with a double to center. Vollmer popped out, then Clint Weaver was intentionally passed. Andy Frazier popped to second on the first pitch to him, but Spider Wilhelm walked to lead the bases. Catcher Lou Heyman then lofted a long fly to left for the third out.

The Pelicans finally broke the ice in the top of the eighth. After Grunwald grounded out, Rice singled to left, stole second and Piver walked. Pete Naton singled to left scoring Rice. Cohen sacri-ficed Piver to third. He scored on a wild pitch, making it 2-0.

Tully had an auspicious begin-ning in the first inning of the second game, striking out the side, although he gave up an infield hit to Gail Healy.

It didn't take the Rebs long in the second game to score their first run since becoming Mont-gomery. Otey led off with a single to deep short and was sacrificed to second by Frazier. Upright flew out to left and Vollmer walked. Then Weaver drove home Otey with a solid one-baser to center. Wilhelm fouled out to end the frame.

The Rebs threatened again in the second on a double by Wells, but he was caught off second. Then Tully singled for what would have been a possible run.

The Pelicans put up a mild threat in the third as Barone doubled to center with one away and went to third on a passed ball, but Tully got out of trouble.

The Johnny Rebs also threat-ened in the third as Upright slapped a long double to left cen-ter. Vollmer followed with a screaming drive to left that Emil Panko caught on the run.

After two were out in the fifth, New Orleans got two men on via a single by Barone and a walk to Johnny Powers. But Healey grounded out to first to kill the threat.

The Pels took the lead in the sixth. Panko led off by drawing a base on balls and Grunwald bounced a fluke double over first base, moving Panko to third. Rice flew out to left, scoring one run, then Piver singled Grunwald in. Joe Kraut flew out to center, then Dangleis beat out an infield hit to put men on first and second. Barone cracked a single to left, scoring Piver with Dangleis hold-ing at second. Powers flew out to right to end the inning.

The Rebels got one run back in the bottom of the sixth before the game was suspended. After two were out Weaver walked and Spider Wilhelm singled to left.

FIRST GAME

NEW ORLEANS	AB	R	H	O	A	E
Barone, ss	4	3	0	4	3	0
Powers, rf	4	0	1	3	0	0
Healey, cf	4	0	1	2	0	0
Panko, lf	4	0	1	3	0	0
Grunwald, 1b	4	0	0	1	0	0
Rice, 2b	1	1	3	4	0	0
Piver, 3b	2	1	0	2	0	0
Naton, c	3	0	1	2	1	0
Cohen, p	2	0	1	0	0	0
Totals	28	5	7	27	18	0

MONTGOMERY

AB	R	H	O	A	E	
Otey, 2b	3	0	0	3	7	0
Wells, cf	4	0	0	0	0	0
Upright, rf	4	0	1	1	2	0
Vollmer, lf	4	0	1	1	0	0
Weaver, 1b	3	0	0	15	0	0
Frazier, ss	3	0	0	3	4	0
Wilhelm, 3b	1	0	0	1	3	0
Heyman, c	3	0	0	3	1	0
Fletcher, p	2	0	1	0	2	0
Frederick, p	1	0	0	0	0	0
Voiselle, p	0	0	0	0	0	0
Totals	28	0	2	27	18	0

2-grounded out for Fletcher in eighth.

New Orleans.....000 000 000-3
Montgomery.....000 000 000-0

RBI—Naton, 2b—Vollmer, Up-right, 3b—Rice, 5—Cohen, DP—Piver, Rice and Grunwald; Wil-helm, Otey and Weaver; Frazier and Weaver; Fletcher, Frazier and Weaver; Otey and Weaver; LOB—New Orleans 3, Montgomery 1, RB—Off Cohen 3-4, Fletcher 4, N—Off Fletcher 4 in 4 innings; off Vo-sell 1 in 1, no runs. R-ER—Fletch-er (2-3), WP—Fletcher, Winner—Cohen (2-4), Loser—Fletcher (4-7), U—Strocchia, Gabella and Burns, T—2-97.

SECOND GAME

NEW ORLEANS	AB	R	H	O	A	E
Barone, ss	4	0	3	1	1	0
Powers, rf	2	0	0	0	0	0
Healey, cf	2	0	1	2	0	0
Panko, lf	2	1	0	3	0	0
Grunwald, 1b	3	1	1	5	0	0
Rice, 2b	1	0	0	2	0	0
Piver, 3b	1	1	2	0	0	0
Kraut, c	2	0	0	3	1	0
Dangleis, p	1	0	1	0	1	0
Phillips, p	0	0	0	0	0	0
Totals	24	3	7	18	5	0

MONTGOMERY

AB	R	H	O	A	E	
Otey, 2b	2	1	1	1	1	0
Frazier, ss	2	0	0	0	0	0
Upright, rf	3	0	1	1	0	0
Vollmer, lf	2	0	0	2	0	0
Weaver, 1b	2	1	1	4	0	0
Wilhelm, 3b	3	0	0	1	0	0
Wells, cf	3	0	2	4	0	0
Frederick, c	2	0	0	3	0	0
Heyman, c	1	0	0	1	0	0
Tully, p	2	1	0	0	0	0
Voiselle, p	0	0	0	0	0	0
Totals	33	2	7	18	2	0

New Orleans.....000 000-3
Montgomery.....100 001-1

(Suspended, series.)

E-3 RBI—Rice, Piver, Barone, Weaver, Wells, 2B—Barone, Grunwald, Wells, Upright, S—Frazier, SF—Rice, Left—New Orleans 3, Montgomery 6, RB—Off Dangleis 2, Tully 4, SO—By Dangleis 2, Phillips 1, Tully 5, R—Off Tully 5 in 3 1/3; Off Dangleis 6 in 3 2/3; R-ER—Tully 2-3; Dangleis 2-2, WP U—Gabella, Burns, Strocchia, T—1-35, A-4,377.